> countries. Thus, when the biggest pandemic of the century struck, various questions were raised about India's ability to fight it: From where will India get the money from to buy so many vaccines from other countries? When will India get the vaccine? Will the people of India even get the vaccine or not? Will India be able to vaccinate enough people to stop the pandemic from spreading? All these were answered by achieving this feat of administering 100 crore vaccinations that too free of cost to the people. India's vaccination drive has operated with a single mantra that if the disease does not discriminate, then there cannot be any discrimination in the vaccination, that's why it was ensured that the VIP culture of entitlement does not dominate the vaccination campaign. Regardless of class, money, access and privilege—every person was treated equally to get the vaccine.[9]

Speaking on vaccine hesitancy that is plaguing many nations, the prime minister said, 'Questions were raised whether most people in India would even go to the vaccination centre to get vaccinated. Vaccine hesitancy remains a major challenge even today in many major developed countries of the world. But the people of India have answered by taking 100 crore vaccine doses. The GoI made public participation the first line of defence in the country's fight against the pandemic.'[10]

He further expressed how the entire vaccination journey was a science-based one,

> It is a matter of pride for all of us that the entire vaccination program of India has been science born, science driven and science-based. Before the vaccine was made and until the vaccine was administered, the entire campaign was based on a scientific approach. We encountered significant challenges in first scaling up production followed by distributing the vaccines to different states and timely delivery of vaccines to far-flung areas. But, with scientific methods and new innovations, the country has found solutions to these challenges. Resources were increased with extraordinary speed. The CoWin platform, made in India, not only made it convenient for people to register for taking the vaccine but also made the work of our medical staff easier.[11]